

TB Distortion

Version: 1.3.0 | Documentation date: 2026-08-04

Overview

Creates anything from gentle warmth to aggressive breakup and blends it with the original sound.

What this plug-in solves

One distortion curve rarely covers subtle saturation, broken-speaker aggression, folded digital motion, and reactive dynamics. TB Distortion combines a main drive engine with an independently controlled TB layer so color can be built in parallel rather than forced through one serial algorithm.

What you can expect

- Controlled harmonic enrichment
- Aggressive clipping and folding textures
- Input-responsive distortion movement
- Band-focused parallel character without unnecessary low-end damage

How it works

TB Distortion reshapes the waveform so new harmonics appear around the original tone. Gentle settings make the source feel warmer and denser; stronger settings flatten and break up peaks until the effect becomes an obvious part of the sound design.

The distortion type establishes the basic texture, while Drive determines how hard the source enters that texture. Tone-focused controls decide which parts of the sound become aggressive, dynamics controls keep the result from feeling flat, and Mix returns as much of the clean source as needed for clarity and impact.

Quick start

- 1 Set Mix fully wet while learning the distortion character and keep safe output headroom.
- 2 Choose a Drive Type and raise Drive to the desired core texture.
- 3 Set Low and High to protect or emphasize a band.
- 4 Adjust Dynamics for reactive movement.

- 5 Add TB Drive and choose its type.
- 6 Back Mix down for parallel use, then level-match Output.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Main Drive and Drive Type

Drive feeds Soft, Hard, Fuzz, Tube, Tape, or Fold shaping. Soft and Tube are progressive; Hard and Fuzz are more abrupt; Tape rounds transients; Fold creates complex non-linear inversion.

Dynamics

Negative and positive Dynamics settings change how distortion intensity follows input level. Use small values first; extremes intentionally exaggerate movement.

TB layer

TB Drive controls the parallel character layer. Level, Sample, Time, and Bias types introduce different amplitude, stepped, time-varying, or asymmetrical behavior.

Low and High focus

The steep focus limits define which region is emphasized by the distortion structure. Raise Low to protect sub-bass; lower High to keep fizz out of the result.

Mix and Output

Mix blends the complete processed path with the original. Output compensates level so tone decisions are not confused with loudness.

Factory Programs

Programs move from clean heat and tube bloom to diode crack, worn reel, folded motion, and radio breakdown. Treat them as routings and gain-stage starting points.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Drive	Sets how strongly the sound is pushed into harmonic color or distortion. Level-match the result and listen for lost transients or harsh buildup. More color is useful only while the source still keeps its role in the mix.
Drive Type	Chooses the main distortion character, from soft and warm to hard or folded. Level-match the result and listen for lost transients or harsh buildup. More color is useful only while the source still keeps its role in the mix.
Dynamics	Changes how distortion follows playing level. Negative and positive values create different kinds of movement. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
High	Sets the highest frequency included in the focused distortion area. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Low	Sets the lowest frequency included in the focused distortion area. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Mix	Blends the original sound with the processed sound. Turn the processed sound up temporarily to learn its character, then return to the mix and keep only the amount that supports the source.
Output	Sets the final listening level after processing. Match the final loudness before deciding whether the processing sounds better. Extra level can make almost any setting seem more impressive.
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.

Control	What it does and when to use it
TB Drive	Adds a second, parallel layer of distortion character. Level-match the result and listen for lost transients or harsh buildup. More color is useful only while the source still keeps its role in the mix.
TB Type	Chooses how the parallel TB layer changes the sound. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.

Practical uses

Parallel vocal grit

- Choose Tube or Tape.
- Raise Low to keep plosives clean.
- Add a small Bias or Sample TB layer.
- Reduce Mix until diction remains clear.

Expected result: The vocal gains urgency and harmonic detail while remaining intelligible.

Destroyed drum loop

- Choose Fold or Fuzz.
- Drive hard and narrow the focus range.
- Use Time or Sample TB character.
- Automate Mix for transitions.

Expected result: The loop becomes unstable and aggressive while the dry path can preserve impact.

Common pitfalls

High Drive and Fold settings can create strong aliasing and level increase. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

Protect monitoring level before changing presets. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

Use Output to compare at equal loudness. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.